Annotated Bibliography

Bates, E., ""You Better Work": Underground Dance Music in New York City by Kai Fikentscher" (2005). CUNY Academic Works. https://academicworks.cuny.edu/gc_pubs/485

Literature review that synthesizes Fikentscher's ethnography of New York's underground dance scene. Emphasizes the club as a space, shaped by Black & Latinx queer communities, where marginal identities developed artistic/personal agency.

Born, G., & Devine, K. (2016). Gender, Creativity and Education in Digital Musics and Sound Art. Contemporary Music Review, 35(1), 1–20. https://doi.org/10.1080/07494467.2016.1177255

Born and Devine analyze the factors that have historically shaped electronic music. They argue that music technology remains overwhelmingly male-dominated due to cultural norms and educational inequities.

Edwards, C. (2025). 'Hit that perfect beat, boy': Queer dance, Hi-NRG, and ephemerality in the AIDS crisis in Thatcher's Britain. DIY, Alternative Cultures & Society, 3(3), 312-325. https://doi.org/10.1177/27538702251362061

Focuses on the emerging Hi-NRG subgenre in Britain in the 1980s and contends that the physical significance of the autonomous dancing queer body remains radically symbolic and critical in a period in which queer bodies were too often discriminately depicted in the context of anxiety and infection.

Fallon, Patric. "Sophie: 'Bipp.'" Pitchfork, Pitchfork, 19 June 2013, pitchfork.com/reviews/tracks/15625-sophie-bipp/.

Fallon's review identifies "Bipp" as a groundbreaking intervention in club music due to SOPHIE's refusal of conventional drops in favor of hyper-synthetic sound design.

Jones, Phoebe. "Identity in Excess: Trans Identities Expressed through Hyperpop." The University of North Carolina at Greensboro, ProQuest, 2024. Web. 3 Nov. 2025. https://libres.uncg.edu/ir/uncg/f/Jones_uncg_0154M_14115.pdf

Jones's thesis paper explores how the hyperpop movement created soundscapes where trans and nonbinary identities are expressed through vocal manipulation, digital excess, and aesthetic exaggeration. Drawing on queer theory and pop musicology, Jones argues that hyperpop's

excess functions as a refusal of binary gender norms that destabilizes mainstream expectations of authenticity and embodiment.

Peacock, William, “How Electronic Music Pioneer Wendy Carlos Reinvented Synthesizers, Bach, and Herself.” CRB, 17 Oct. 2025, www.classicalwcrb.org/blog/2025-10-17/how-electronic -music-pioneer-wendy-carlos-reinvented-synthesizers-bach-and-herself.

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Chung, Holly. “Wendy Carlos: Synth Genius”, *KDFC.* (2025). https://www.kdfc.com/articles/wendy-carlos-synth-visionary

Profiles on Wendy Carlos + her role as a pioneer whose technical and creative contributions made expressive electronic sound accessible to the mainstream. The first article highlights Carlos’s transition and how the prejudice surrounding it shaped her career, the second article provides more detailed information on her background and upbringing.

Soudant, Luca. "Trans*formative Thinking Through Sound: Artistic Research in Gender and Sound Beyond the Human" *Open Philosophy*, vol. 4, no. 1, 2021, pp. 335-346. https://doi.org/10.1515/opphil-2020-0189

Soudant critiques how sound is coded as masculine (loud) or feminine (quiet) and develops the concept of “sonic manspreading” to expose these gendered connotations of power. Soudant also argues that vibration can reveal and subvert social hierarchies.

Strong, C., & Gadir, T. (2023). ‘This felt more like a conversation’: challenging gender norms in electronic music production through alternative education programs. Continuum, 37(4), 448–464. https://doi.org/10.1080/10304312.2023.2271683

Strong and Gadir use a case study to examine how academic environments structured around inclusion can dismantle hierarchies that have historically marginalized trans and gender-nonconforming producers.

Thompson, Andrew, "Transgender Voices in Composition: Exploring the Relationship Between / Gender Identity and Music Composition" (2023). University Honors Theses. Paper 1373. https://doi.org/10.15760/honors.1404

Thompson explores how transgender identity shapes the compositional process through their own work, as well as interviews with composer Sarah Hennies; argues that trans composers use sound and physicality to reimagine musical norms.

"The 200 Greatest Songs By 21st Century Women+", (2018). NPR: https://www.npr.org/2018/07/30/627395449/turning-the-tables-the-200-greatest-songs-by-21st-century-women-part-1

This NPR list documents influential 21st-century songs by women across genres, including rock, pop, hip-hop, and electronic music.

Vozick-Levinson, Simon. "Sophie Is Gone, and It's Okay to Cry." Rolling Stone, Rolling Stone, 31 Jan. 2021, www.rollingstone.com/music/music-features/sophie-okay-to-cry-1121468/.

This Rolling Stone article memorializes SOPHIE after her death in 2021. It follows her accomplishments within PC Music, mainstream pop, and club culture. Serves as documentation of her influence on the convergence of experimental EDM and pop music.

Image & Video Sources

Adam, S. "May 17 1965, Moog introduces the first analog synthesizer", (2012): Creative Audio Works. https://creativeaudioworks.com/tag/roger-mcguinn/

Against Me!"Transgender Dysphoria Blues", (2014). Total Treble.https://youtu.be/zccutrnwZn4?si=oQEpkktUmbqfRkFr (and) https://genius.com/Against-me-transgender-dysphoria-blues-lyrics

"Anthems For A Seventeen-Year-Old Girl", *Yeule.* (2024): https://youtu.be/PshxeE7Ot7c?si=pb6au3Aeu3pc6QBt

BBC Two, "Wendy Carlos Interview", (1989). BBC https://youtu.be/Z3cab5IcCy8?si=xYjnH6QGXaiDHysT

"BIPP", *SOPHIE* (2013). https://youtu.be/MVc3Z-bG6Eo?si=_opYQKbLOjKNfU1k

"Bitch I'm Madonna", *Madonna* (2015). https://youtu.be/7hPMmzKs62w?si=Opy_CvpPzjI2rrVC

Carlos, W. "Switched-On Bach" (1968). https://archive.org/details/wendy-carlos-witched-on-bach

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DJ Sprinkles. “Grand Central Pt. 1 (MCDE Bassline Dub)”, (2012) https://youtu.be/dBGiwK_GoY0?si=jTRrupV2yqob985S

“Honey Dijon | TURNT: The DJ Life Ep 4”, (2014). VLife. https://youtu.be/BWMON9jp0-8?si=dYSaY2KE76gG_E8G

“I Don’t Want It At All”, *Kim Petras* (2017) https://youtu.be/JC9FA8lZRy8?si=PqpUKMv4LVzxkr1M

“Lemonade”, *McDonald’s* (2015). https://youtu.be/BTYITNM1K-s?si=2Z7Oux1vR6PtLmex

“La Chiqui”, *Arca, SOPHIE* (2020) https://youtu.be/WfbGfk_Q1L8?si=nYWmJol2D1U2-EK4

“Mequetrefe”, *Arca* (2020) https://youtu.be/AZKPd3k6O6A?si=QXB6WI8OIkK9c-s4

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